

## JSS 1 CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES (CRS) LESSON NOTES

### FIRST TERM

| Week  | Topic                                       | Content                                                                                 |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | God and His Creation                        | Who is God? (Gen. 1:1; Jer. 10:12)                                                      |
| 2     | The Creation Story                          | Biblical account of creation in Genesis 1                                               |
| 3     | The Creation of Man and Woman               | Genesis 2:4–24                                                                          |
| 4     | Purpose of Creation                         | Reasons why God created human beings; Songs about creation                              |
| 5     | <b>Midterm Examinations</b>                 | —                                                                                       |
| 6     | Marriage                                    | Meaning of marriage (Gen. 2:22-25); Functions of marriage (Eph. 5:21-31)                |
| 7     | <b>Midterm Break</b>                        | —                                                                                       |
| 8     | Marriage II                                 | Types of marriage; Importance of marriage                                               |
| 9     | Disobedience I                              | Meaning of disobedience; Adam & Eve's disobedience (Gen. 3:1-19)                        |
| 10    | Disobedience II                             | Consequences of Adam & Eve's disobedience; Human disobedience and national disobedience |
| 11–13 | <b>Revision, Examinations &amp; Closing</b> | —                                                                                       |

## WEEK 1: GOD AND HIS CREATION

### Introduction to God and His Creation

Christian Religious Studies teaches that God is the supreme, eternal, and all-powerful Creator of the universe. The Bible presents God as the origin of all life, the sustainer of the world, and the one worthy of worship and obedience. Understanding who God is helps believers appreciate His nature, His works, and their relationship with Him.



### Who is God?

- **Definition and Nature of God:**

God is an eternal, infinite, and all-powerful being who exists outside the limitations of

time and space. He is the Creator, Preserver, and Judge of all creation. God is also loving, just, merciful, and holy.

- **Biblical References:**

- **Genesis 1:1** – “In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth.” This verse establishes God as the origin of all things, highlighting His power and sovereignty.
- **Jeremiah 10:12** – “He has made the earth by His power, He has established the world by His wisdom, and has stretched out the heavens by His understanding.” This verse emphasizes God’s wisdom, power, and authority over creation.

- **Attributes of God:**

- **Omnipotent:** God is all-powerful and capable of doing anything that is consistent with His nature.
- **Omniscient:** God is all-knowing and understands all things, past, present, and future.
- **Omnipresent:** God is present everywhere at all times.
- **Loving and Merciful:** God shows care, compassion, and forgiveness to His creation.
- **Just and Righteous:** God’s actions are always fair, morally right, and perfect.

### **God as Creator**

- God created the universe and everything within it, including the earth, sky, seas, plants, animals, and human beings.
- Creation is a reflection of God’s power, wisdom, and creativity.
- The act of creation demonstrates that God is purposeful and intentional; nothing in the universe exists by chance.

- Human beings, created in God's image (Genesis 1:27), are unique and have the responsibility to care for the rest of creation.



### Importance of Knowing God as Creator

1. **Develops Worship and Reverence:** Understanding God's role as Creator inspires praise, worship, and obedience.
2. **Encourages Responsibility:** Humans are called to care for God's creation, promoting environmental stewardship.
3. **Strengthens Faith:** Knowledge of God's power and wisdom builds trust in His guidance and protection.
4. **Provides Moral Direction:** Recognizing God as Creator helps believers understand the purpose of life and live righteously.

### Summary

God is the eternal, all-powerful, and all-wise Creator of the universe. Through scripture, particularly Genesis 1:1 and Jeremiah 10:12, believers learn about God's nature, His attributes,

and His relationship with creation. Understanding God as Creator helps Christians develop worship, reverence, responsibility, and faith in His guidance.

## **EVALUATION**

1. Define who God is according to the Bible.
2. Mention two attributes of God.
3. How does Genesis 1:1 describe God's role in creation?
4. Explain why humans are considered unique in God's creation.
5. Give two reasons why knowing God as Creator is important.

## **ASSIGNMENT**

1. Write a short essay on "*The Power and Wisdom of God as Creator.*"
2. List five examples from nature that reflect God's creative power and explain how each demonstrates His wisdom.

## WEEK 2: THE CREATION STORY

### *Biblical Account of Creation in Genesis 1*

The creation story is found in the **book of Genesis chapter 1**. Genesis is the first book of the Bible, and it begins by explaining how God created the world and everything in it. The word *Genesis* means “beginning,” and it records the beginning of the world, the beginning of human life, and the beginning of God’s relationship with man.

The creation story shows that God is the Almighty Creator who made the heavens and the earth out of nothing by the power of His word. The story is divided into **six days of creative work and one day of rest**.

### **The Biblical Account of Creation (Genesis 1:1–31, 2:1–3)**

- **Day 1:** God created light. He separated the light from darkness and called the light *Day* and the darkness *Night*.
- **Day 2:** God created the firmament (the sky or heaven) to separate the waters above from the waters below.
- **Day 3:** God gathered the waters together to form seas and allowed dry land to appear, which He called Earth. He also created vegetation — plants, grass, and fruit-bearing trees.
- **Day 4:** God created the heavenly bodies: the sun to rule the day, the moon to rule the night, and the stars to shine.
- **Day 5:** God created living creatures in the waters (fishes and sea animals) and birds to fly in the sky.
- **Day 6:** God created animals that live on land (domestic and wild animals). Finally, God created man and woman in His own image and likeness. He blessed them, gave them authority to dominate the earth, and commanded them to be fruitful and multiply.
- **Day 7:** God finished His work and rested. He blessed the seventh day and made it holy.



## THE SIX DAYS OF CREATION



### Lessons from the Creation Story

1. God is the Supreme Creator of everything in the universe.
2. God created everything in an orderly manner and not by accident.
3. Man is the most special of God's creation, made in His image and likeness.
4. The creation story shows God's love, as He provided everything man would need before creating man.
5. God gave man responsibility to take care of the earth and its creatures.
6. The Sabbath day (seventh day) is a day of rest and should be kept holy.

## **Difference between the Creation of Man and Other Creatures**

- Man was created in God's image and likeness, unlike other creatures.
- Man was given authority to rule over the earth, while other creatures were created to serve man.
- God personally formed man and breathed into him the breath of life, while other creatures came into being through spoken words.
- Man was given wisdom, intelligence, and the ability to distinguish between right and wrong.

## **Evaluation**

1. In which book of the Bible is the creation story found?
2. Mention the things God created on the first, second, and third days.
3. State three things God created on the sixth day.
4. Why is man considered the most special of God's creation?
5. What did God do on the seventh day, and why is it important?

## **Assignment**

1. Write out in your exercise book the seven days of creation in their correct order.
2. Explain two lessons you can learn from the creation story that can guide your daily life.



### WEEK 3: THE CREATION OF MAN AND WOMAN

*(Genesis 2:4–24)*

The creation of man and woman is one of the most important events recorded in the Bible. According to **Genesis 2:4–24**, God created man and woman in a special way, different from the rest of creation. This passage helps us to understand the uniqueness of human beings, their relationship with God, and their roles in the world.



#### Account of the Creation of Man (Genesis 2:7)

The Bible records that after God had created the heavens, the earth, plants, and animals, He formed the first man, **Adam**, out of the dust of the ground. Then, God **breathed into his nostrils the breath of life**, and Adam became a living being. This shows that man is both physical (from dust) and spiritual (from God's breath).

God placed Adam in the **Garden of Eden**, a beautiful garden with rivers, trees, and fruits, to live in and take care of. He was given authority over the animals and all of God's creation, showing man's responsibility as a caretaker and ruler under God's authority.

### **Account of the Creation of Woman (Genesis 2:18–22)**

While Adam was in the garden, God saw that it was **not good for man to be alone**. He needed a companion and helper. God first brought all the animals to Adam to name them, but none was found suitable to be his partner.

So, God caused Adam to fall into a deep sleep. While Adam slept, God took one of his ribs and closed up the place with flesh. From the rib, God made the first woman, **Eve**, and brought her to Adam.

When Adam saw her, he said:

*"This is now bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh; she shall be called Woman, because she was taken out of man."* (Genesis 2:23)

This shows the closeness and unity between man and woman.

### **The Institution of Marriage (Genesis 2:24)**

The passage concludes with the origin of marriage. The Bible says:

*"Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall become one flesh."*

This means that marriage was instituted by God for companionship, unity, love, and continuity of the human race.

### **Lessons from the Creation of Man and Woman**

| <b>Lesson</b>              | <b>Explanation</b>                                    |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Man is special in creation | God personally formed man and breathed life into him. |

|                             |                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| God provides for man        | The Garden of Eden shows God's care in giving man food, shelter, and beauty. |
| Man has responsibilities    | Adam was placed in the garden to work and take care of it.                   |
| Companionship is God's plan | Woman was created to be a helper and companion for man.                      |
| Unity in marriage           | Marriage unites man and woman as "one flesh."                                |
| Dependence on God           | Human beings depend on God for life, purpose, and survival.                  |

### **Importance of the Creation Story**

- It teaches that God is the Creator of all life.
- It shows that human beings are the highest of God's creation.
- It explains the origin of man, woman, and marriage.
- It reveals the close relationship between man and woman.
- It emphasizes that man has work to do and must be responsible.
- It teaches that companionship and love are part of God's plan for humanity.

### **Evaluation**

1. From which material did God create man?
2. How did God give life to Adam?
3. Why did God decide to create a woman?
4. From what part of man was the woman created?
5. State three lessons from the creation of man and woman.

## Assignment

Write short notes on the following:

- (a) The uniqueness of man in creation.
- (b) The importance of marriage as shown in Genesis 2:24.



## WEEK 4: PURPOSE OF CREATION

*Reasons why God created human beings; Songs about creation*

### Meaning of Creation

- Creation is the act of bringing something into existence out of nothing.
- According to the Bible (Genesis 1–2), God created the heavens, the earth, plants, animals, and human beings.
- Creation shows God’s power, wisdom, and love.



### Reasons Why God Created Human Beings

1. **For Fellowship with Him** – God created man in His image (Genesis 1:26–27) so that humans can relate with Him, worship Him, and enjoy His presence.
2. **To Care for and Rule over Other Creatures** – God gave man dominion over the fish, birds, and every living thing (Genesis 1:28). Humans were created to be caretakers of creation.

3. **To Be Fruitful and Multiply** – Man was created to reproduce and fill the earth with people (Genesis 1:28).
4. **To Work and Be Productive** – God placed Adam in the Garden of Eden to till and keep it (Genesis 2:15). Humans were created to work and contribute positively to the world.
5. **To Obey and Glorify God** – Human beings were created to live in obedience to God and give Him glory through their lives.
6. **To Enjoy God’s Blessings** – God created humans to share in His goodness, love, and abundant creation.
7. **To Live in Harmony** – God created man and woman to live together in love, unity, and peace.

### **Biblical References**

- Genesis 1:26–31 – Creation of man in God’s image.
- Genesis 2:15 – God placed Adam in the garden to work and keep it.
- Psalm 19:1 – Creation reveals God’s glory.
- Isaiah 43:7 – Man was created for God’s glory.

### **Songs About Creation**

1. *“All things bright and beautiful, the Lord God made them all.”*
2. *“He’s got the whole world in His hands.”*
3. *“O Lord my God, how great Thou art.”*

*(Teacher may encourage students to sing one or two songs in class to reinforce the lesson.)*

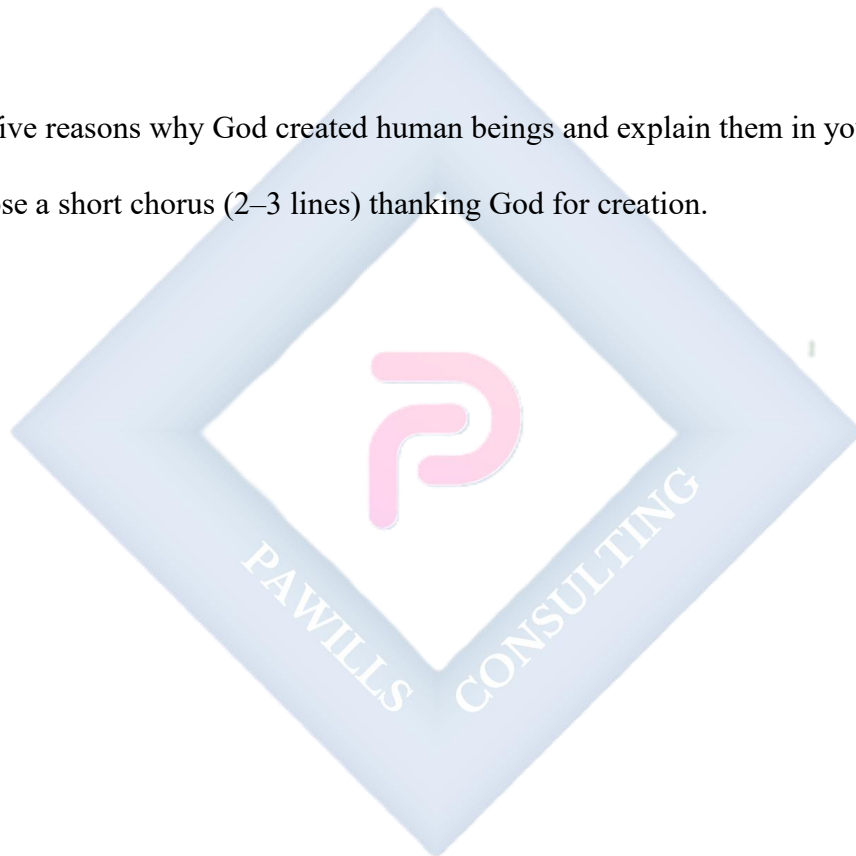
### **Evaluation**



1. Define creation.
2. Mention three reasons why God created human beings.
3. State one Bible reference that explains the purpose of man's creation.
4. What task did God give Adam in the Garden of Eden?
5. Mention two songs that talk about creation.

### **Assignment**

- Write five reasons why God created human beings and explain them in your own words.
- Compose a short chorus (2–3 lines) thanking God for creation.



## WEEK 6: MARRIAGE

Marriage is one of the most important institutions established by God for humanity. It is the foundation of family life and is highly valued in both Christian teachings and society. In this lesson, we will explore the **meaning of marriage** according to the Bible and the **functions of marriage** as explained in the scriptures.



### MEANING OF MARRIAGE (GENESIS 2:22–25)

Marriage, according to the Bible, is a sacred union between a man and a woman as ordained by God. In Genesis 2:22–25, we learn that God created woman from the rib of man to be his companion. After creating Eve, God brought her to Adam, and Adam recognized her as “bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh.”

This passage teaches that marriage:

- **Is instituted by God:** It was God's idea for man and woman to live together in love and unity.
- **Is a union of companionship:** God said, "It is not good that the man should be alone," so He made a helper suitable for him.
- **Creates a lifelong bond:** Verse 24 states, "Therefore a man shall leave his father and his mother and hold fast to his wife, and they shall become one flesh." This shows that marriage establishes a permanent, intimate relationship between husband and wife.
- **Is based on love, trust, and mutual support:** The couple is expected to live together in harmony and faithfulness.

Thus, marriage is not just a social contract but a divine covenant blessed by God.

### **FUNCTIONS OF MARRIAGE (EPHESIANS 5:21–31)**

In Ephesians 5:21–31, Apostle Paul explains the responsibilities and purposes of marriage for Christians. These include:

1. **Companionship and Love:**  
Marriage provides a partner with whom one shares life's joys, sorrows, and challenges. Paul teaches that husbands should love their wives as Christ loved the Church, and wives should respect their husbands. This mutual love strengthens the bond between spouses.
2. **Procreation and Continuation of Human Race:**  
One of the primary purposes of marriage is to bring children into the world and raise them in a loving and godly environment.
3. **Mutual Support and Care:**  
Spouses are to support one another physically, emotionally, and spiritually. They are to encourage each other in faith and daily living.

**4. Moral and Sexual Purity:**

Marriage provides a proper and godly setting for sexual relations, helping to prevent immorality and unfaithfulness.

**5. Symbol of Christ's Relationship with the Church:**

Paul compares marriage to the relationship between Christ and the Church. Just as Christ is faithful to the Church, so should a husband be faithful to his wife, and a wife to her husband.

**IMPORTANCE OF MARRIAGE TO CHRISTIANS**

- It fulfills God's plan for humanity.
- It builds strong families and societies.
- It helps individuals grow in love, patience, and responsibility.
- It reflects the love of God in human relationships.

**EVALUATION:**

1. What is the meaning of marriage according to Genesis 2:22–25?
2. Explain two reasons why God instituted marriage.
3. Mention three functions of marriage as taught in Ephesians 5:21–31.
4. How is Christian marriage similar to Christ's relationship with the Church?
5. Why is marriage important in society today?

**ASSIGNMENT:**

Write out Genesis 2:24 and explain its meaning in your own words. Also, discuss how Christian couples can show love and respect to each other in marriage.

## WEEK 8: MARRIAGE II

Marriage is a fundamental institution in Christian teaching, regarded as a sacred union between a man and a woman. It serves as a foundation for family life, social stability, and spiritual growth. Beyond its spiritual significance, marriage has social, emotional, and economic implications, and understanding its types and importance helps students appreciate its role in both personal and societal development.

### Types of Marriage

Marriage can take various forms, reflecting cultural, religious, and legal perspectives:

1. **Monogamy**

Monogamy is the union of one man and one woman. It is the most widely recognized form of marriage in Christian teachings. Monogamous marriages emphasize fidelity, mutual respect, and shared responsibilities, fostering a stable environment for raising children and building strong family relationships.

2. **Polygamy**

Polygamy involves one man marrying multiple wives. While it exists in some cultures, it is generally not encouraged in Christian doctrine, which promotes monogamy as the ideal. Polygamous marriages require careful management to ensure fairness, harmony, and equitable treatment of all partners.

3. **Civil Marriage**

Civil marriage is conducted and recognized by the government under statutory laws. It involves legal registration and provides legal rights and obligations for both spouses, including inheritance, property ownership, and child custody.

4. **Religious Marriage**

Religious marriage is solemnized according to religious rites and ceremonies. In Christianity, this involves vows before God and witnesses, signifying a covenantal relationship that is spiritually binding and morally significant.

### Importance of Marriage

Marriage serves several essential purposes in individual lives and society:

## THE IMPORTANCE OF MARRIAGE



**COMPANIONSHIP**  
Emotional Support  
& Friendship



**PROCREATION**  
Family & Legacy



**SOCIAL STABILITY**  
Foundation of Society



**SPIRITUAL  
SIGNIFICANCE**  
Sacred Bond & Unity

- **Spiritual Significance:** Marriage is a sacred covenant reflecting God's design for companionship, love, and mutual support. It mirrors the relationship between Christ and the Church.
- **Companionship and Emotional Support:** It provides partners with emotional intimacy, friendship, and mutual encouragement.
- **Procreation and Family Life:** Marriage creates a stable environment for raising children and ensuring the continuity of society.
- **Social Stability:** By regulating relationships and responsibilities, marriage contributes to order, social cohesion, and moral discipline.
- **Economic Cooperation:** Spouses often share resources, work together for family sustenance, and support each other in personal and professional endeavors.

In summary, marriage is both a spiritual and social institution that requires commitment, mutual respect, and understanding. Recognizing its types and importance equips students with knowledge for future life, personal relationships, and responsible citizenship.

### Evaluation

1. List and explain the four types of marriage.
2. Why is monogamy considered the ideal in Christian teaching?



3. Mention three reasons why marriage is important to society.
4. How does civil marriage differ from religious marriage?
5. Explain how marriage contributes to family stability.

### **Assignment**

Write a short essay titled: **“The Importance of Marriage in Christian Life.”** Include discussions on its types and how marriage supports family, society, and spiritual growth.



## WEEK 9: DISOBEDIENCE I

*Meaning of Disobedience; Adam and Eve's Disobedience (Genesis 3:1–19)*



### Meaning of Disobedience

Disobedience means the refusal to obey instructions, rules, laws, or commands given by someone in authority. It is going against what is expected of us by God, parents, teachers, elders, or leaders. Disobedience shows lack of respect, self-control, and regard for authority.

In the Bible, disobedience is often regarded as sin because it is a direct violation of God's commandments. To disobey is to choose one's own will instead of following the will of God or the guidance of rightful authority.

Examples of disobedience include:

- A child refusing to do what his or her parents instructed.

- A student refusing to follow school rules.
- A person telling lies instead of the truth.
- Adam and Eve disobeying God in the Garden of Eden.

### **Adam and Eve's Disobedience (Genesis 3:1–19)**

Adam and Eve were the first human beings created by God. They lived in the Garden of Eden, a beautiful and peaceful place where they had everything they needed. God gave them the freedom to eat from any tree in the garden except the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. God warned them that the day they ate from that tree, they would surely die.

However, the serpent (Satan) deceived Eve. He told her that if she ate the fruit, she would not die but would become like God, knowing good and evil. Eve listened to the serpent and took the fruit. She ate it and gave some to Adam, and he also ate.

The moment they disobeyed God's command, their eyes were opened, and they realized they were naked. They felt ashamed and tried to cover themselves with leaves. When God came to the garden, Adam and Eve hid themselves. God asked Adam why he was hiding, and Adam said it was because he was naked. When God questioned him further, Adam blamed Eve, and Eve blamed the serpent.

Because of their disobedience, God pronounced punishment on them:

- The serpent was cursed to crawl on its belly and eat dust.
- Enmity was placed between the serpent and the woman's offspring.
- Eve was punished with pain in childbirth and submission to her husband.
- Adam was punished with hard labor; he would struggle to produce food from the ground.
- Finally, they were driven out of the Garden of Eden and denied access to the tree of life.

This was the beginning of human suffering, sin, and separation from God.

### **Lessons from the Disobedience of Adam and Eve**

1. Disobedience brings consequences and suffering.
2. We must resist temptation no matter how attractive it looks.
3. Sin separates man from God.
4. We should take responsibility for our actions instead of blaming others.
5. God loves us but punishes sin because He is just.

### **Evaluation**

1. What is disobedience?
2. Mention two examples of disobedience in everyday life.
3. Summarize the story of Adam and Eve's disobedience.
4. State three punishments that came upon Adam and Eve because of their disobedience.
5. Give two lessons Christians should learn from Adam and Eve's disobedience.

### **Assignment**

Write a short essay explaining **two ways students disobey in school** and **the possible consequences of such disobedience**.

## WEEK 10: DISOBEDIENCE II

The story of Adam and Eve in the book of Genesis provides the foundation for understanding disobedience to God and its consequences. After God created Adam and Eve and placed them in the Garden of Eden, He gave them freedom to eat from every tree except the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. Unfortunately, Adam and Eve disobeyed God by eating the forbidden fruit.

The **consequences of Adam and Eve's disobedience** were both immediate and long-lasting. Immediately, they became aware of their nakedness and felt shame and guilt. They lost their innocence and could no longer enjoy perfect fellowship with God. They were driven out of the Garden of Eden, and humanity became subject to suffering, hardship, pain, and death. Eve was told that she would experience pain in childbirth, while Adam was condemned to labor hard to cultivate the land for survival. Above all, their sin brought separation between humanity and God, introducing sin into the world.





In addition to Adam and Eve's disobedience, human disobedience in general continues to have serious effects. When individuals choose to disobey God, they often face personal consequences such as guilt, shame, lack of peace, suffering, or punishment. Disobedience also brings about a broken relationship with God, leading to spiritual emptiness. For example, disobeying God's commandments by lying, stealing, or engaging in immoral behavior often results in loss of trust, conflict, and negative outcomes in society.

On a larger scale, there is also **national disobedience**. This occurs when an entire nation turns away from God's laws and instructions. In the Bible, the people of Israel often suffered defeat, famine, and exile because of their collective disobedience to God. In the same way, when a country embraces corruption, injustice, immorality, and neglect of God's will, it experiences national problems such as poverty, insecurity, underdevelopment, war, and natural disasters. National disobedience brings about the withdrawal of God's blessings, leaving the nation vulnerable to calamity and destruction.

In summary, disobedience—whether personal or collective—always leads to negative consequences. God desires obedience because it brings blessings, peace, prosperity, and fellowship with Him. Disobedience, on the other hand, brings suffering, punishment, and separation from God.

**Evaluation:**

1. State three consequences of Adam and Eve's disobedience.
2. Explain what is meant by human disobedience.
3. What is national disobedience? Give one example from the Bible.
4. Mention two results of national disobedience.

**Assignment:**

Write an essay on how disobedience affects your relationship with God, your family, and your community.



## JSS 1 CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES (CRS) LESSON NOTES

### SECOND TERM

| Week  | Topic                                       | Content                                                                                                  |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Call to Repentance I                        | Meaning of repentance; King David's repentance (2 Sam. 12:7-13; Psalm 51)                                |
| 2     | Call to Repentance II                       | The people of Nineveh repent (Jonah 3:1-10)                                                              |
| 3     | Call to Repentance III                      | John the Baptist calls for repentance (Luke 3:1-14)                                                      |
| 4     | Call to Repentance IV                       | Jesus commends Zacchaeus (Luke 19:8); Consequences of lack of repentance (1 Sam. 3:18; 4:10-21)          |
| 5     | <b>Midterm Examinations</b>                 | —                                                                                                        |
| 6     | Call to Obedience I                         | Meaning of obedience; Abraham obeys God's call (Gen. 12:1-9)                                             |
| 7     | <b>Midterm Break</b>                        | —                                                                                                        |
| 8     | Call to Obedience II                        | Abraham's blessings (Gen. 17:1-21); Abraham's sacrifice of Isaac (Gen. 21:1-8; 22:1-19)                  |
| 9     | Call to Service I                           | Meaning of service; Joseph's and Ruth's examples (Gen. 37:12-36; 41:37-57; Ruth 1:15; 2:7-18)            |
| 10    | Call to Service II                          | Lessons from Joseph & Ruth; Life in God's service (1 Pet. 2:18-25); Problems in service; Call to service |
| 11-13 | <b>Revision, Examinations &amp; Closing</b> | —                                                                                                        |

## WEEK 1: CALL TO REPENTANCE I

### Introduction to Repentance

Repentance is one of the central themes in the Christian faith. It means turning away from sin and sincerely returning to God. When a person repents, he or she feels sorrow for doing wrong, confesses the sin before God, and makes a firm decision not to repeat it. Repentance brings forgiveness, restores a broken relationship with God, and gives peace of mind.

The Bible constantly calls men and women to repentance, showing that sin separates people from God, but repentance leads to reconciliation with Him. To repent is not just to feel sorry, but to experience a complete change of heart, attitude, and behavior.



### Meaning of Repentance

Repentance can be defined as the act of feeling genuine sorrow for one's sins, confessing them, seeking forgiveness, and turning away from them to live a new life that pleases God. It is both an inward change of the heart and an outward change of conduct.

Repentance involves three main steps:

1. **Realization of Sin:** A person must recognize that he or she has done wrong and fallen short of God's standards.
2. **Confession of Sin:** The person openly admits the sin to God and, where necessary, to others wronged.
3. **Turning Away from Sin:** Repentance is complete only when the individual forsakes sinful habits and chooses to live in obedience to God.

Repentance is important because it leads to forgiveness, cleanses the conscience, restores peace with God, and helps one to grow in holiness.

### **King David's Repentance (2 Samuel 12:7–13; Psalm 51)**

King David was a man after God's heart, but he sinned greatly when he committed adultery with Bathsheba and arranged for her husband, Uriah, to be killed in battle (2 Samuel 11). This act displeased God, and He sent the prophet Nathan to rebuke David.

- **Nathan's Message (2 Sam. 12:7–13):** Nathan told David a parable that revealed his sin, and when David realized the gravity of his offense, he admitted his guilt. David said, "I have sinned against the Lord." This was his moment of repentance. God forgave David, although he still faced consequences for his actions.
- **David's Prayer of Repentance (Psalm 51):** In this psalm, David poured out his heart to God, asking for mercy and forgiveness. He acknowledged his sins, expressed deep sorrow, and begged God to cleanse him, create a pure heart within him, and restore the joy of salvation. This prayer is a classic example of true repentance.

David's repentance teaches that:

- No matter how great a sin is, God forgives when one repents sincerely.
- Repentance must come from the heart, not just from fear of punishment.
- A repentant person should desire renewal and transformation of life, not just forgiveness.

## **Lessons from David's Repentance**

1. Everyone is capable of sin, no matter how close they are to God.
2. God is merciful and ready to forgive anyone who repents genuinely.
3. Repentance requires humility and honesty before God.
4. Sin has consequences, but repentance brings restoration and peace.
5. A true repentant heart desires to live righteously and avoid repeating past mistakes.

## **Summary**

Repentance means turning away from sin and returning to God with a sincere heart. King David's story shows that even great leaders can fall into sin, but God's mercy is available when they repent. David's prayer in Psalm 51 remains a model for Christians today, reminding us that genuine repentance involves confession, sorrow for sin, and a desire for renewal.

## **EVALUATION**

1. Define repentance in your own words.
2. Mention three steps involved in repentance.
3. Narrate briefly the story of David's sin and his repentance.
4. What lessons can Christians learn from David's repentance?
5. Why is repentance important in the life of a Christian?

## **ASSIGNMENT**

1. Write a short essay explaining the difference between feeling sorry for a mistake and true repentance.

2. Read Psalm 51 carefully and pick out five phrases that show David's deep sorrow and desire for forgiveness.



## WEEK 2: CALL TO REPENTANCE II

### *The People of Nineveh Repent (Jonah 3:1–10)*

The call to repentance is an important theme in the Bible. It shows that although God hates sin, He is merciful to forgive anyone who turns away from their evil deeds. One of the best examples of repentance is found in the story of Jonah and the people of Nineveh.



### **Background of the Story:**

Nineveh was the capital city of Assyria, a very powerful empire in Old Testament times. The people of Nineveh were known for their wickedness, cruelty, violence, and idolatry. Their sins were so great that they attracted God's judgment. God wanted to destroy Nineveh, but in His mercy, He decided to first give them a chance to repent.

God commanded Jonah, a Hebrew prophet, to go to Nineveh and warn the people of their coming destruction. At first, Jonah disobeyed and tried to run away to Tarshish. But after God disciplined him by allowing him to be swallowed by a great fish for three days and nights, Jonah prayed and repented. The fish vomited him out, and he finally obeyed God's command to go to Nineveh.



### **Jonah's Preaching in Nineveh:**

When Jonah entered the great city of Nineveh, he began to preach God's message, walking around the city and crying out:

**"Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown!"**

This was a simple but powerful warning. It meant that within forty days, if they did not change their ways, Nineveh would be destroyed by God.

### **The Response of the People of Nineveh:**

The people of Nineveh responded in a surprising and sincere way:

- They immediately believed the message of God through Jonah.
- They declared a fast, refusing to eat or drink as a sign of humility and sorrow for their sins.
- They put on sackcloth, which was a rough and uncomfortable garment worn to show repentance.
- Everyone, from the greatest to the least, participated in this act of repentance.

### **The King's Example:**

The king of Nineveh set the best example. When he heard Jonah's message:

- He rose from his throne and removed his royal robe, showing humility before God.
- He put on sackcloth and sat in ashes, a symbol of sorrow and repentance.
- He proclaimed a decree that no person or animal should eat or drink until they had cried out to God.
- He commanded everyone to turn away from their evil ways and violence, hoping that God would have mercy on them.

### **God's Response to Nineveh:**

God saw the sincerity of their repentance. He noticed that they were not only fasting and praying but also turning away from their wicked behavior. Because of this, God showed mercy to them. He did not destroy Nineveh as He had threatened.

This shows us the nature of God. He is holy and just, but He is also loving and merciful. He punishes sin, but He forgives those who repent sincerely.

### Lessons from the Repentance of the Ninevites

1. **God gives warnings before judgment.** He does not punish immediately but gives sinners an opportunity to repent.
2. **Repentance must be genuine.** It involves not only saying “sorry” but also forsaking sinful actions and changing one’s behavior.
3. **Leadership matters.** The king of Nineveh humbled himself and led his people by example, showing that leaders must guide their subjects in righteousness.
4. **Prayer and fasting are powerful tools.** When combined with a sincere heart, they can bring forgiveness and deliverance.
5. **God’s mercy is for everyone.** It does not matter how sinful or wicked people have been; if they repent, God is willing to forgive.
6. **Judgment can be delayed or cancelled.** God postponed the destruction of Nineveh because of their repentance, proving that our actions can influence God’s decision.
7. **Repentance brings peace and restoration.** Nineveh was saved from destruction and given another chance because they humbled themselves before God.

### Differences Between Remorse and Repentance

- **Remorse** means feeling sorry or guilty after committing a sin, but without necessarily changing one’s behavior.
- **Repentance** means feeling sorry for sin and deciding to completely turn away from it, never to return.

The Ninevites did not only feel remorse; they repented by abandoning their evil ways.

## **Evaluation**

1. Who was the prophet that God sent to Nineveh, and what was his message?
2. How did the people of Nineveh show that they believed Jonah's message?
3. Describe at least three things the king of Nineveh did when he heard Jonah's preaching.
4. What was God's reaction to the repentance of Nineveh?
5. Mention four lessons Christians today can learn from the story of the people of Nineveh.
6. Differentiate between remorse and repentance with examples.

## **Assignment**

1. Write a detailed account of how the people of Nineveh repented after hearing Jonah's message.
2. In your own words, explain how prayer, fasting, and repentance can bring about God's forgiveness today.
3. Imagine that you are Jonah in your town. Write the message you would preach to call your community to repentance from social evils such as corruption, violence, dishonesty, and idolatry.

### WEEK 3: CALL TO REPENTANCE III – JOHN THE BAPTIST CALLS FOR REPENTANCE

(Luke 3:1–14)

Repentance is one of the central messages in the Bible. It means turning away from sin and turning back to God with a sincere heart. In the New Testament, **John the Baptist** was the prophet specially called by God to prepare the way for the coming of Jesus Christ. His main message was a call for repentance and readiness for the Kingdom of God.



#### Background of John the Baptist's Ministry (Luke 3:1–6)

John began his ministry during the reign of Emperor Tiberius and under the religious leadership of Annas and Caiaphas, the high priests. He lived in the wilderness, dressed in camel's hair, and ate locusts and wild honey (Matthew 3:4).

God gave him a divine assignment to preach in the region of the River Jordan, telling people to repent because the Messiah (Jesus Christ) was about to be revealed. John fulfilled the prophecy

of Isaiah: *“The voice of one crying in the wilderness, prepare the way of the Lord, make His paths straight.”*

### **John’s Message of Repentance (Luke 3:7–9)**

When multitudes came to him for baptism, John warned them to produce the fruit of true repentance. He called them a “generation of vipers” and warned them that being descendants of Abraham was not enough to save them.

He explained that God expects everyone to show evidence of repentance through righteous living. He warned them of God’s coming judgment, saying that every tree that does not bear good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.

### **John’s Instructions to the People (Luke 3:10–14)**

The people asked John what they should do to show repentance. He gave them practical instructions:

| <b>Group</b>   | <b>John’s Instructions</b>                                                                                                      | <b>Meaning/Explanation</b>                                                  |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| General Crowd  | Share with others – anyone with two coats should give one to someone without, and those with food should share with the hungry. | Repentance must show in generosity, love, and kindness.                     |
| Tax Collectors | Collect no more than what is required.                                                                                          | They were known for cheating people; repentance meant honesty and fairness. |
| Soldiers       | Do not extort money, do not accuse people falsely, and be content with your wages.                                              | They must stop oppression and live with integrity.                          |

Through these teachings, John showed that repentance is not just about words but about changed behaviour and actions.

## Lessons from John the Baptist's Call to Repentance

| Lesson                     | Explanation                                                                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Repentance is necessary    | Everyone must repent to receive forgiveness and prepare for God's kingdom.          |
| Repentance must bear fruit | True repentance shows in behaviour such as honesty, kindness, and contentment.      |
| God's judgment is real     | Those who refuse to repent will face destruction.                                   |
| Righteousness is practical | Repentance affects daily life – how we treat others, how we work, and how we live.  |
| No one is above repentance | Even descendants of Abraham needed to repent; family background cannot save anyone. |

### Relevance of John's Call Today

- People must repent of corruption, dishonesty, and violence.
- Leaders should rule with fairness and justice.
- Citizens must show love and kindness by helping those in need.
- Christians should live lives that reflect the change that repentance brings.
- Everyone should prepare for the second coming of Jesus Christ.

### Evaluation

1. Who was John the Baptist and what was his mission?
2. Summarize John's message in Luke 3:7–9.

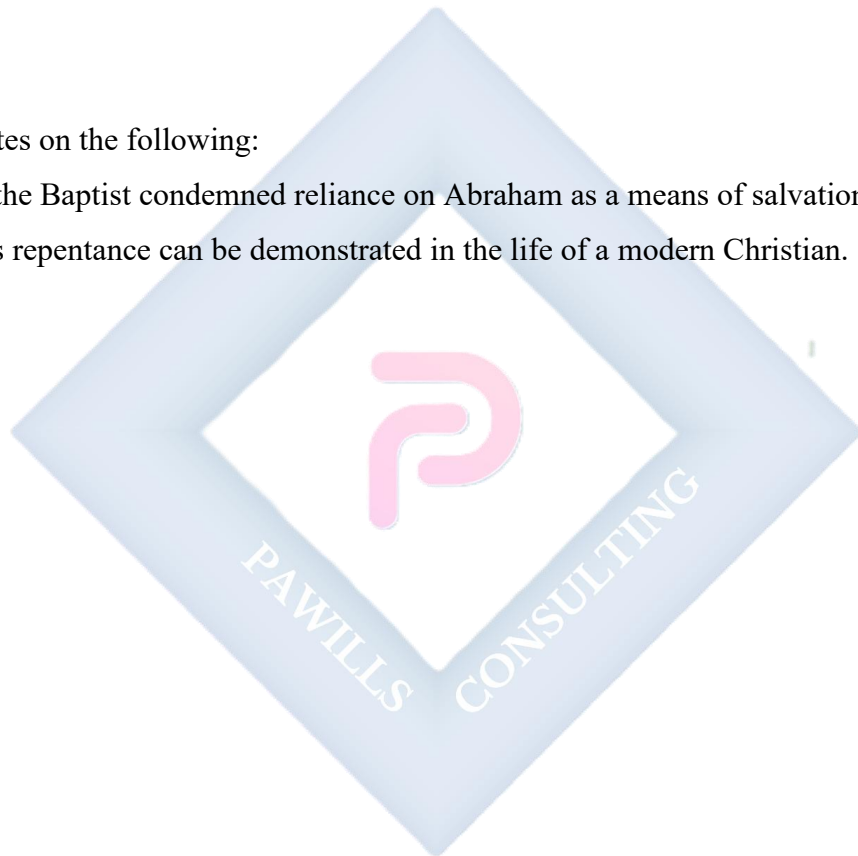


3. What instructions did John give to:
  - (a) the general crowd
  - (b) the tax collectors
  - (c) the soldiers?
4. State three lessons Christians can learn from John's call to repentance.
5. Why is repentance still important in our society today?

### **Assignment**

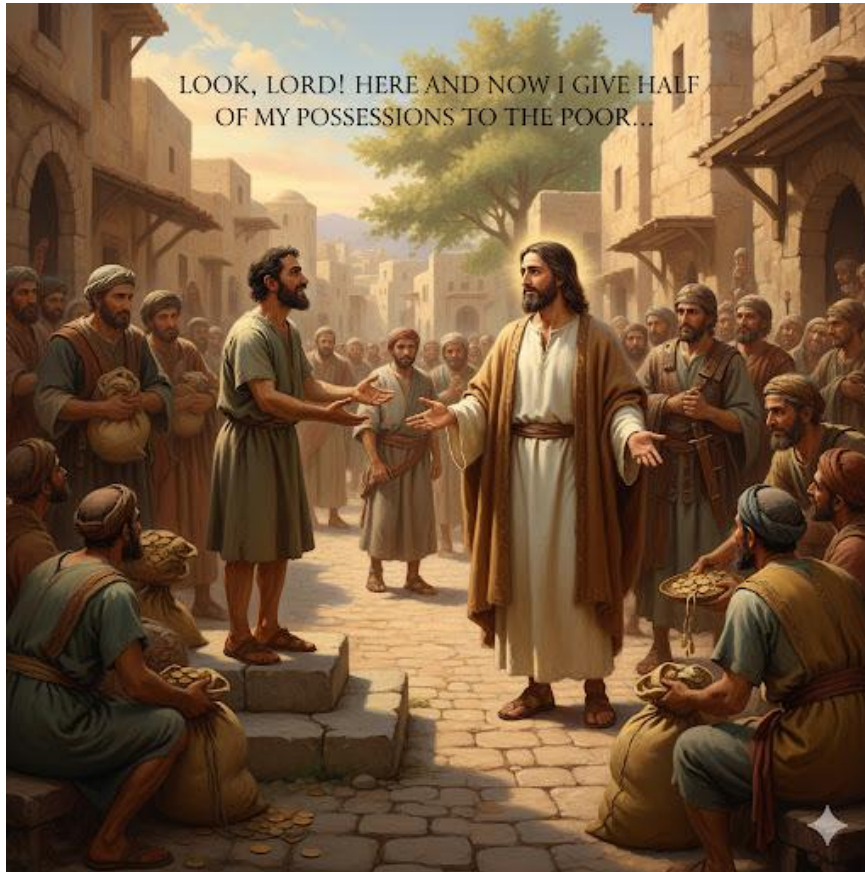
Write short notes on the following:

- (a) Why John the Baptist condemned reliance on Abraham as a means of salvation.
- (b) Three ways repentance can be demonstrated in the life of a modern Christian.



## WEEK 4: CALL TO REPENTANCE IV

*Jesus Commends Zacchaeus (Luke 19:8); Consequences of Lack of Repentance (1 Samuel 3:18; 4:10–21)*



### Meaning of Repentance

- Repentance is a **complete turnaround from sin to righteousness**.
- It involves:
  - Recognizing one's sins.
  - Feeling genuine sorrow for wrongdoing.
  - Confessing sins to God.
  - Asking for forgiveness through faith in Christ.

- Making restitution where necessary (correcting the wrong done).
- Living a new life that pleases God.
- Without repentance, forgiveness cannot be obtained (Luke 13:3).
- Repentance is not just saying “I am sorry,” but showing it through actions and lifestyle changes.

## **The Story of Zacchaeus (Luke 19:1–10)**

### **Background of Zacchaeus**

- Zacchaeus was a chief tax collector in Jericho.
- Tax collectors were seen as **corrupt, dishonest, and sinful** because they cheated people by collecting more than required.
- Despite his wealth, Zacchaeus was rejected socially and spiritually by the Jewish community.

### **His Encounter with Jesus**

- Zacchaeus desired to see Jesus but was too short to see over the crowd.
- Out of determination, he climbed a sycamore tree.
- Jesus, seeing his faith and eagerness, stopped and called him by name: *“Zacchaeus, make haste and come down; for today I must stay at your house.”*
- This shocked the crowd because they saw Zacchaeus as a sinner unworthy of Jesus’ attention.

### **Zacchaeus’ Repentance (Luke 19:8)**

- Zacchaeus immediately confessed his sins and took action:
  - He promised to give **half of his wealth to the poor**.
  - He pledged to **restore four times** whatever he had stolen or taken unjustly.

- This act was **restitution** – proof of genuine repentance.

### **Jesus' Commendation**

- Jesus said: *"Today salvation has come to this house, because he also is a son of Abraham. For the Son of Man came to seek and to save that which was lost."*
- This showed that repentance brings forgiveness, restoration, and acceptance into God's family.

### **Lessons from Zacchaeus**

1. No sinner is beyond redemption when they genuinely repent.
2. True repentance must involve restitution – correcting wrongs done to others.
3. God looks at the heart, not outward appearance.
4. Social rejection does not stop God's love; Jesus welcomes even those despised by society.
5. Determination and humility are necessary in seeking God.
6. Repentance leads to salvation, joy, and acceptance in God's kingdom.

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### **Consequences of Lack of Repentance – Eli and His Sons (1 Samuel 3:18; 4:10–21)**

#### **Background**

- Eli was a priest and judge in Israel.
- His sons, Hophni and Phinehas, served as priests but lived sinful lives:
  - They disrespected God's sacrifices.
  - They committed immorality in the temple.
  - They oppressed the people who came to worship.
- Eli warned them but failed to discipline them properly.

- God sent warnings through Samuel that judgment would come upon Eli's household if they refused to repent.

### **The Judgment**

- In a battle with the Philistines, Israel carried the Ark of God, believing it would guarantee victory.
- Instead, Israel suffered a heavy defeat:
  - 30,000 soldiers died.
  - The Ark of God was captured.
  - Hophni and Phinehas were killed.
- When Eli heard the news, he fell backward from his chair, broke his neck, and died.
- Phinehas' pregnant wife, upon hearing the news, went into labor, gave birth, and named her son **Ichabod**, meaning "*The glory has departed from Israel.*"

### **Lessons from Eli's Family**

1. Failure to repent leads to destruction and God's judgment.
2. Sin affects not just the sinner but also family, community, and nation.
3. Religious leaders must correct sin firmly; compromise brings disaster.
4. God's presence departs when sin is tolerated.
5. God is merciful, but continued disobedience provokes His anger.
6. Ichabod reminds us that when sin rules, God's glory departs.

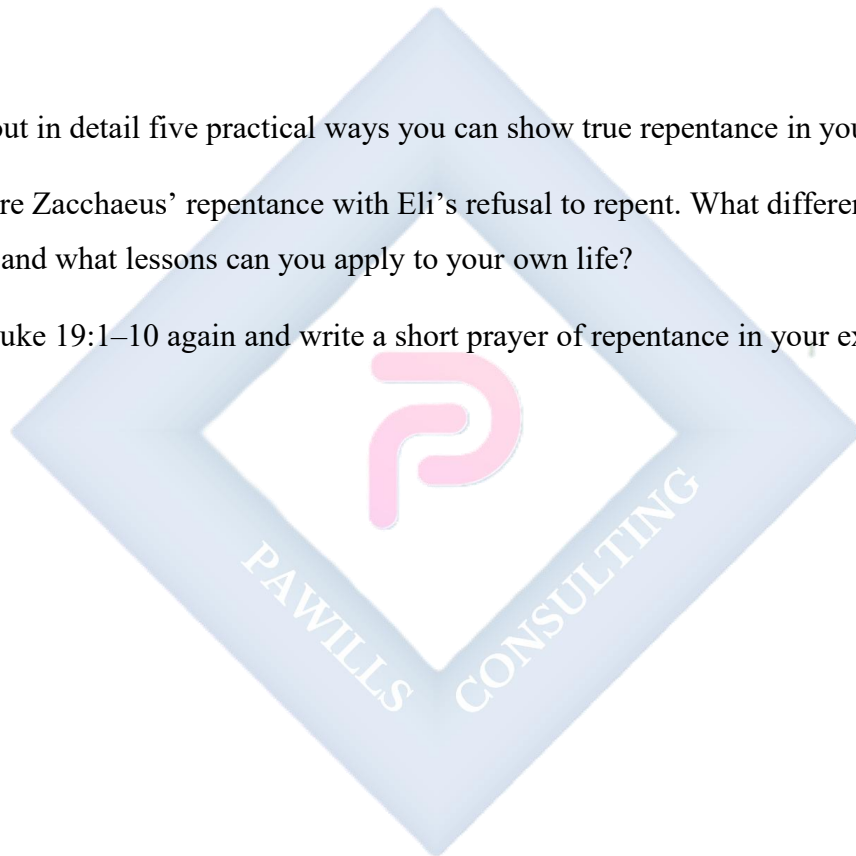
### **Evaluation**

1. Define repentance and explain its main steps.
2. Narrate the story of Zacchaeus and his encounter with Jesus.

3. How did Zacchaeus prove his repentance was genuine?
4. State four lessons Christians can learn from Zacchaeus.
5. What sins did Eli's sons commit?
6. Mention at least three consequences of Eli and his sons' refusal to repent.
7. What does *Ichabod* mean, and what is its significance?

### Assignment

1. Write out in detail five practical ways you can show true repentance in your daily life.
2. Compare Zacchaeus' repentance with Eli's refusal to repent. What differences do you notice, and what lessons can you apply to your own life?
3. Read Luke 19:1–10 again and write a short prayer of repentance in your exercise book.





## WEEK 6: CALL TO OBEDIENCE I

The call to obedience is one of the most important themes in the Bible. God requires His children to listen to His voice and carry out His instructions completely and faithfully. Without obedience, it is impossible to walk with God. Disobedience separates man from God, while obedience attracts His blessings, protection, and favor. In this lesson, we will study the **meaning of obedience** and learn from the example of **Abraham, who obeyed God's call in Genesis 12:1–9**.



### MEANING OF OBEDIENCE

Obedience means doing what one is told to do, following rules, laws, or instructions given by someone in authority. In the Christian sense, obedience is **hearing God's word and acting on it** without argument or hesitation. It is not partial compliance but total submission to the will of God.

For example, when God gives a command in the Bible, the believer is expected to obey promptly and without excuses. Failure to obey leads to sin, disappointment, and sometimes punishment. On the other hand, obedience brings blessings, promotion, and a closer relationship with God.

Obedience to God therefore involves three major elements:

1. **Listening:** Paying attention to God's word through the Bible, prayers, and the teachings of spiritual leaders.
2. **Trusting:** Believing that God's instructions are for our good, even when they seem difficult or do not make sense immediately.
3. **Acting:** Taking practical steps to carry out what God has commanded fully, willingly, and faithfully.

Disobedience often arises from pride, fear, doubt, or lack of faith. However, true obedience is proof of love for God, as Jesus Himself said, "If you love me, keep my commandments" (John 14:15).

### **ABRAHAM OBEYS GOD'S CALL (GENESIS 12:1-9)**

Abraham, then known as Abram, lived in Haran with his family. God appeared to him and gave him a special instruction that would change his life forever.

#### **1. The Call:**

God commanded Abraham to leave his country, his relatives, and his father's house and go to a land that He would show him. The instruction was not an easy one because it meant leaving behind his comfort zone, his culture, his people, and the things he was familiar with.

#### **2. The Promise:**

God gave Abraham several promises if he obeyed. These included:

- God would make him into a great nation.
- God would bless him and make his name great.
- God would make him a blessing to others.

- Whoever blessed Abraham would be blessed, and whoever cursed him would be cursed.
- Through him, all the families of the earth would be blessed.

These promises showed that obedience to God always comes with reward.

### **3. The Response:**

Abraham did not argue with God. He did not delay or complain. He trusted God's words and immediately obeyed. He took his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, and all their possessions and left Haran to begin the journey to the land of Canaan.

### **4. Worship:**

When Abraham reached the land of Canaan, he built altars to the Lord and called on His name. This act showed his faith and gratitude to God. It also revealed that Abraham was not only physically obedient in moving to a new land but also spiritually devoted to God in worship.

## **IMPORTANCE AND LESSONS FROM ABRAHAM'S OBEDIENCE**

1. **Faith in God:** Abraham's obedience shows that faith and obedience go hand in hand. True faith in God is demonstrated by obedience to His instructions.
2. **Sacrifice is sometimes required:** Abraham had to leave his comfort zone, family ties, and security to follow God's command. Obedience often demands sacrifice.
3. **Obedience brings blessings:** Abraham's life proves that when we obey God, He rewards us with blessings beyond our imagination. Abraham later became the father of many nations, just as God had promised.
4. **God's promises are sure:** Even though Abraham did not see immediate results, God's promises to him were fulfilled. This teaches that God always keeps His word.
5. **Obedience influences others positively:** Through Abraham, all the nations of the earth were blessed. Our obedience can have a positive impact on our family, community, and even generations after us.
6. **Obedience strengthens relationship with God:** Each act of obedience deepens our trust in God and strengthens our walk with Him.

## **PRACTICAL APPLICATION TO STUDENTS' LIVES**

- Just as Abraham obeyed God, students are expected to obey God by respecting their parents, teachers, school rules, and the laws of the nation.
- Obedience in little things (such as honesty, punctuality, respect, and doing assignments) prepares us to handle bigger responsibilities.
- Christians must learn to obey God even when it is not convenient, because God knows what is best for us.

## **EVALUATION:**

1. Define obedience in the Christian context.
2. State three elements of obedience to God.
3. Narrate the story of Abraham's call in Genesis 12:1–9.
4. Mention at least three promises God made to Abraham when He called him.
5. Explain three lessons Christians can learn from Abraham's obedience.
6. Why is obedience sometimes difficult for Christians, and how can they overcome this challenge?

## **ASSIGNMENT:**

Write an essay of not less than one and a half pages on the topic: **“The Importance of Obedience in the Life of a Christian Student.”** In your essay, use Abraham's story as an example and show how obedience to God can lead to blessings in the life of young people today.

## WEEK 8: CALL TO OBEDIENCE II

Obedience is a key virtue in Christian life. It means total submission to God's word, commands, and instructions without resistance or questioning. Obedience requires trust, humility, and faith. The life of **Abraham**, known as the "Father of Faith," shows that obedience to God, even when it is difficult, brings blessings, covenant relationships, and divine favor. In this lesson, we will study **Abraham's blessings** and his **sacrifice of Isaac**, two remarkable events that teach us that obeying God is always rewarding, even if it involves sacrifice or delay.



### Abraham's Blessings (Genesis 17:1–21)

When Abraham was ninety-nine years old, God appeared to him and renewed His covenant. God commanded Abraham to “walk before Me and be blameless,” meaning he should live a life of righteousness and total obedience. In return, God made promises that are known today as **Abraham's blessings**.



1. **Covenant of Nations:** God changed Abram's name to Abraham, meaning "father of many nations," to signify the fulfillment of His promise. This shows that Abraham's descendants would become great nations, spiritually and physically.
2. **Blessing of Descendants:** God promised that kings and nations would come from Abraham's lineage. Despite Abraham and Sarah's old age, God promised Sarah would give birth to a son, Isaac, through whom the covenant would continue.
3. **Everlasting Covenant:** The agreement was not just for Abraham, but for his descendants forever. This was a covenant of relationship, protection, and divine favor.
4. **The Land of Canaan:** God promised to give Abraham and his descendants the land of Canaan as an everlasting possession.
5. **The Sign of Circumcision:** God instructed Abraham that every male among his descendants must be circumcised as a permanent sign of the covenant. Circumcision symbolized separation, holiness, and commitment to God's command.

Through these blessings, we see that obedience to God brings both spiritual and physical rewards that extend to generations yet unborn. Abraham's life teaches that God fulfills His promises at His appointed time, and our responsibility is to remain faithful and obedient.

### **Abraham's Sacrifice of Isaac (Genesis 21:1–8; 22:1–19)**

The greatest test of Abraham's obedience came when God asked him to sacrifice Isaac, the child of promise. This event teaches deep lessons about faith, obedience, and God's provision.

1. **The Birth of Isaac (Genesis 21:1–8):**

God kept His word, and Sarah gave birth to Isaac in her old age. Isaac's birth was a miracle and a sign that God's promises never fail, no matter how long it takes. Isaac was dearly loved by Abraham and Sarah because he was the son of promise.

2. **The Test of Faith (Genesis 22:1–10):**

God commanded Abraham to sacrifice Isaac on Mount Moriah. This command tested Abraham's loyalty. Despite the pain and difficulty, Abraham obeyed without hesitation.



because he trusted God completely. His willingness to give up his only son shows that true obedience may demand sacrifice.

**3. Divine Intervention (Genesis 22:11–14):**

As Abraham was about to sacrifice Isaac, God stopped him and provided a ram as a substitute offering. This act shows God's mercy and provision. Abraham named the place **Jehovah Jireh**, meaning "The Lord will provide."

**4. Renewal of the Blessing (Genesis 22:15–19):**

Because Abraham obeyed, God renewed His promises and assured him that his descendants would be as numerous as the stars and the sand by the sea. Nations of the earth would be blessed through his seed.

This story foreshadows God's sacrifice of His only Son, Jesus Christ, for the salvation of humanity. Just as Abraham trusted God with Isaac, Christians are called to trust God with their lives and obey Him without reservation.

**Lessons on Obedience from Abraham**

- **Obedience requires faith:** Abraham trusted God's word, even when it seemed impossible.
- **Obedience may require sacrifice:** Abraham was ready to give up his most precious possession for God.
- **Obedience leads to blessings:** Abraham's faithfulness brought generational blessings.
- **God provides for the obedient:** Just as He provided a ram for Abraham, He always makes a way for those who trust Him.
- **Obedience glorifies God:** By obeying, Abraham honored God, and his story continues to inspire believers today.

**Evaluation**

1. Explain the covenant blessings God gave Abraham in Genesis 17.
2. Why did God ask Abraham to sacrifice Isaac?
3. How did Abraham demonstrate obedience in the sacrifice of Isaac?
4. What does the name **Jehovah Jireh** mean, and what is its significance?
5. Mention three lessons Christians can learn from Abraham's life of obedience.

### **Assignment**

Write a two-page essay on the topic: **"Abraham as a Model of Obedience."**

In your essay, discuss Abraham's blessings and his sacrifice of Isaac, then explain how his example teaches modern Christians to trust and obey God even when it is difficult.



## WEEK 9: CALL TO SERVICE I

*Meaning of Service; Joseph's and Ruth's Examples (Genesis 37:12–36; 41:37–57; Ruth 1:15; 2:7–18)*

### Meaning of Service

Service means working for the benefit of others, contributing positively to their welfare, and showing love, kindness, and helpfulness in practical ways. It is an act of rendering help, support, or assistance without selfish motives.

In Christian teaching, service is not only about helping others but also about doing God's will. Jesus Christ himself described service as the highest calling, saying that he came not to be served but to serve (Mark 10:45).

Service can be expressed in different ways:

- Serving God by obeying His commandments and living righteously.
- Serving parents, teachers, and elders by showing obedience and respect.
- Serving the community by contributing to peace, cleanliness, and development.
- Serving the nation by being patriotic, honest, and hardworking.

True service must be done with humility, faithfulness, and love.

### Joseph as an Example of Service (Genesis 37:12–36; 41:37–57)

Joseph, one of the sons of Jacob, is an excellent biblical example of service. Even though his brothers hated him and sold him into slavery, Joseph remained faithful to God and continued to serve diligently wherever he was placed.

- **Service in Potiphar's house:** When Joseph was sold into Potiphar's house, he served faithfully, and Potiphar entrusted all his household into his care.

- **Service in prison:** After being falsely accused by Potiphar's wife, Joseph was imprisoned. Even in prison, he served by interpreting the dreams of fellow prisoners.
- **Service in Pharaoh's palace:** When Pharaoh had troubling dreams, Joseph was brought from prison to interpret them. By God's wisdom, Joseph gave the correct interpretation and advised Pharaoh to store food during the seven years of plenty. Pharaoh recognized Joseph's wisdom and made him governor over Egypt.

Joseph's faithful service saved not only Egypt but also many nations from famine, including his own family. His life shows that service should be rendered sincerely, no matter the circumstances.

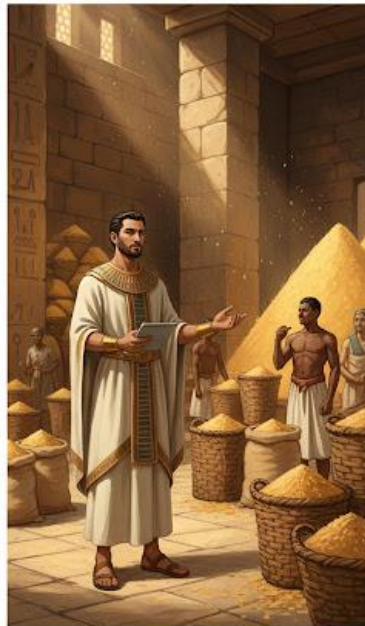
### **Ruth as an Example of Service (Ruth 1:15; 2:7–18)**

Ruth, a Moabite woman, demonstrated service through her loyalty, humility, and hard work. After the death of her husband, she chose to follow her mother-in-law, Naomi, back to Bethlehem instead of returning to her own people. Ruth's decision was a selfless act of service.

RUTH SERVING NAOMI



JOSEPH SERVING PHARAOH



FAITHFUL STEWARDSHIP

- **Service to Naomi:** Ruth cared for Naomi, served her faithfully, and supported her in her old age. She declared, “Your people shall be my people and your God my God” (Ruth 1:16).
- **Hard work in the field:** To provide food for herself and Naomi, Ruth worked diligently in the fields, gleaning leftover grains. She was noticed by Boaz, who admired her devotion and kindness to Naomi.
- **Reward for service:** Ruth’s faithfulness and service brought blessings. She eventually married Boaz, and through her lineage came King David and, ultimately, Jesus Christ.

Ruth’s life teaches that service done with love, humility, and dedication is always rewarded by God.

### Lessons from Joseph and Ruth’s Service

1. Service must be done sincerely and faithfully, even in difficult situations.
2. God blesses those who serve others selflessly.
3. Service requires humility, love, and commitment.
4. By serving others, we also serve God.
5. Service can open doors of opportunity and bring lasting blessings.

### Evaluation

1. Define service in your own words.
2. Mention two ways Christians can serve God and fellow human beings.
3. Explain how Joseph served in Pharaoh’s palace.
4. How did Ruth serve Naomi?
5. State two lessons we can learn from the lives of Joseph and Ruth.

### Assignment

Write a short essay on **“The importance of service in our families and communities”**, using at least two examples from your daily life.





## WEEK 10: CALL TO SERVICE II

The call to service in Christianity emphasizes God's desire for His children to serve Him faithfully and serve others in love. The Bible provides numerous examples of men and women who were called into service and remained faithful despite challenges. Among them are Joseph and Ruth, who demonstrated commitment, humility, and perseverance in their service to God and others.



### 1. **Lessons from Joseph (Genesis 39–50):**

Joseph was sold into slavery by his brothers, but he served diligently in Potiphar's house and later in prison, earning the trust of those around him. Through his faithfulness, God elevated him to become Prime Minister in Egypt. His story teaches that service should not depend on our circumstances. Joseph's service brought salvation to Egypt and surrounding nations during famine. From Joseph, we learn lessons of:

- Faithfulness in little tasks leading to bigger responsibilities.
- Patience, endurance, and forgiveness even in difficult situations.
- Recognizing that service to man is ultimately service to God.

## 2. **Lessons from Ruth (Ruth 1–4):**

Ruth, a Moabite woman, chose to serve her mother-in-law Naomi and follow the God of Israel after the death of her husband. She demonstrated loyalty, humility, and sacrifice. Her hard work in Boaz's field eventually brought blessings not only to herself but to generations after her, as she became the great-grandmother of King David. From Ruth, we learn lessons of:

- Loyalty and selfless service to others, even when inconvenient.
- Humility in service, as she willingly gleaned leftover grains to support Naomi.
- How God rewards those who serve with a pure heart.

## 3. **Life in God's Service (1 Peter 2:18–25):**

Christians are called to serve faithfully, even in challenging situations. Peter encourages believers to endure suffering while doing good, just as Christ suffered for humanity. Service to God requires humility, patience, endurance, and obedience. It also requires us to be examples of Christ in our conduct, showing love and compassion to others.

## 4. **Problems in Service:**

Service is not always easy. Those who serve God may face difficulties such as:

- Discouragement from others.
- Lack of resources or support.
- Misunderstanding and rejection.
- Temptations to give up or pursue selfish interests.
- Persecution or suffering for righteousness.

Despite these challenges, God strengthens and rewards those who remain faithful.

### **5. Call to Service Today:**

Every Christian is called to serve in one way or another. Service can be through evangelism, helping the needy, supporting the church, or using one's talents and skills to glorify God. True service requires humility, faith, love, and perseverance. The call to service is both a privilege and a responsibility for all believers.

### **Evaluation:**

1. Mention three lessons from the life of Joseph concerning service.
2. Explain how Ruth demonstrated loyalty in her service.
3. What does 1 Peter 2:18–25 teach us about service?
4. Identify four challenges that can hinder effective service to God.
5. Why is service considered both a privilege and a responsibility in Christianity?

### **Assignment:**

Write a detailed note on how young people today can serve God faithfully in school, at home, and in society, giving practical examples.

## JSS 1 CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES (CRS) LESSON NOTES

### THIRD TERM

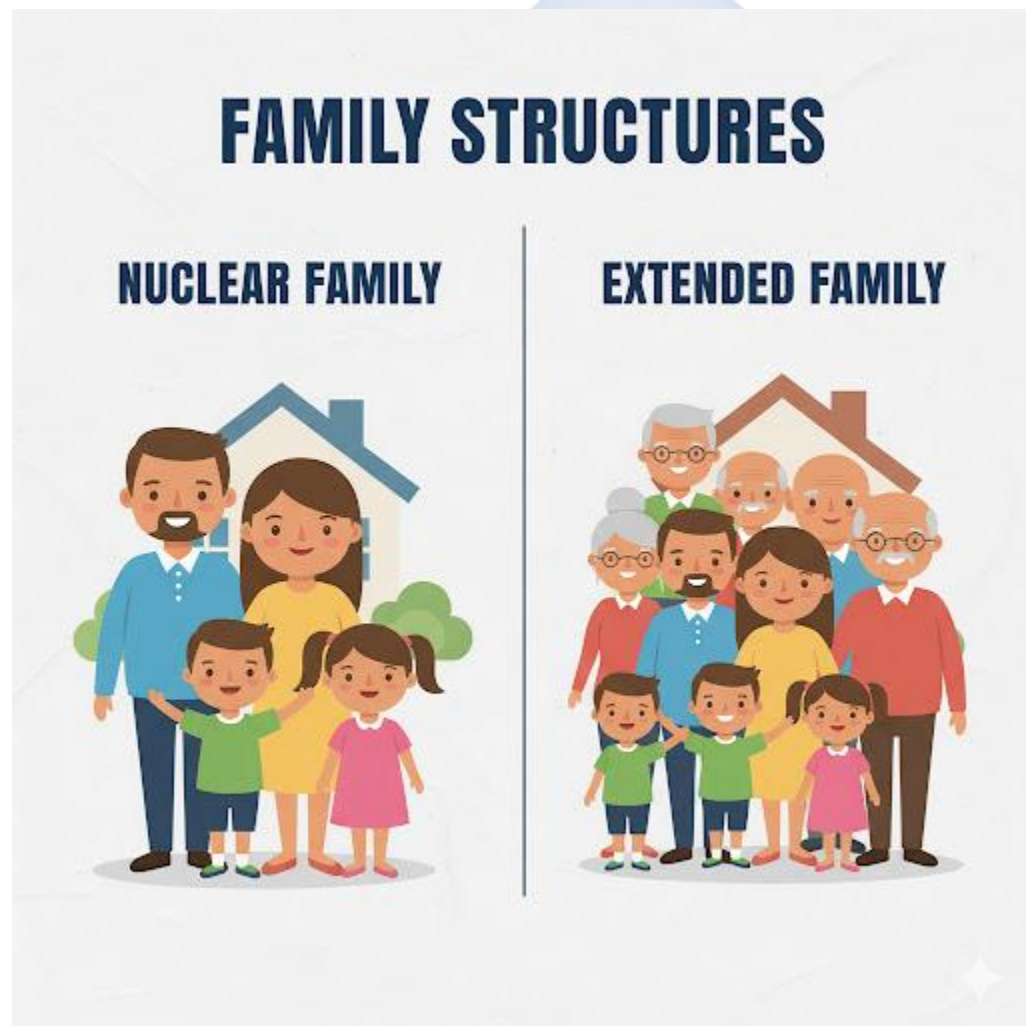
| Week  | Topic                                       | Content                                                                                  |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Relationship in the Family I                | Meaning and types of family; Recognition of family members                               |
| 2     | Relationship in the Family II               | Roles of family members (Eph. 6:1-9; Col. 3:18-21; 1 Pet. 3:1-7)                         |
| 3     | Relationship in the Family III              | Concept of a good family name (Prov. 22:1; Ecc. 7:1)                                     |
| 4     | Relationship in the School I                | Names of members of the school; Choosing friends in school                               |
| 5     | <b>Midterm Examinations</b>                 | —                                                                                        |
| 6     | Relationship in the School II               | Biblical examples of friendship (1 Sam. 18:1-5; Luke 11:5-13)                            |
| 7     | <b>Midterm Break</b>                        | —                                                                                        |
| 8     | Relationship in the School III              | Importance of good friends; Consequences of bad friends (Prov. 1:10-12; 2 Thess. 3:6-13) |
| 9     | Relationship in the Community I             | Community leaders; Ways of sustaining relationships in the community                     |
| 10    | Relationship in the Church                  | Relationship in the church; Importance of fellowship and unity                           |
| 11–13 | <b>Revision, Examinations &amp; Closing</b> | —                                                                                        |

## WEEK 1: RELATIONSHIP IN THE FAMILY I

### Meaning of Family

The family is the smallest unit of society. It is made up of people who are related by blood, marriage, or adoption. It is within the family that individuals first learn values, morals, love, respect, and responsibility. The family is the foundation of society because it trains and nurtures children who will later become members of the larger community.

In the Bible, God created the first family when He made Adam and Eve in the Garden of Eden (Genesis 2:18–25). From them came children and descendants who spread across the earth. God designed the family to be a place of love, support, and guidance.



## Types of Family

There are two major types of families:

### 1. Nuclear Family

- This consists of the father, mother, and their children.
- It is the immediate or basic family unit.
- Example: A man, his wife, and their children living together in one household.

### 2. Extended Family

- This includes the nuclear family plus other relatives such as grandparents, uncles, aunts, cousins, nephews, and nieces.
- In African societies, the extended family is very common because it strengthens bonds and provides support to members.

Other forms of family can also be recognized in society, such as:

- **Single-Parent Family:** A family where either the mother or father takes care of the children due to death, divorce, or separation.
- **Polygamous Family:** A family where a man has more than one wife or, less commonly, a woman has more than one husband.

## Recognition of Family Members

Recognizing family members means knowing and identifying the different people who make up the family and understanding their roles.

- **Father:** Head of the family, protector, provider, and guide.
- **Mother:** Supporter, caretaker, nurturer, and teacher of moral and spiritual values.
- **Children:** Offspring of the parents who are expected to love, respect, and obey their parents and contribute to family unity.
- **Extended Members (grandparents, uncles, aunts, cousins, etc.):** They give advice, guidance, and support.



Family members should recognize and respect one another's positions and responsibilities. For example:

- Children must honor their parents as commanded in Exodus 20:12.
- Parents should love and care for their children (Ephesians 6:4).
- Members of the extended family should support one another in times of need.

### **Importance of Recognizing Family Members**

1. It strengthens love, unity, and peace within the family.
2. It ensures order, respect, and discipline in the home.
3. It helps children to know their identity and heritage.
4. It promotes care and support among relatives.
5. It reflects God's plan for harmony and fellowship in human society.

### **Biblical Teachings about the Family**

The Bible emphasizes respect, love, and care in the family. For example:

- In Ephesians 6:1–3, children are commanded to obey their parents.
- Colossians 3:18–21 instructs husbands, wives, and children to love and respect one another.
- Proverbs 22:6 encourages parents to train up a child in the way he should go.

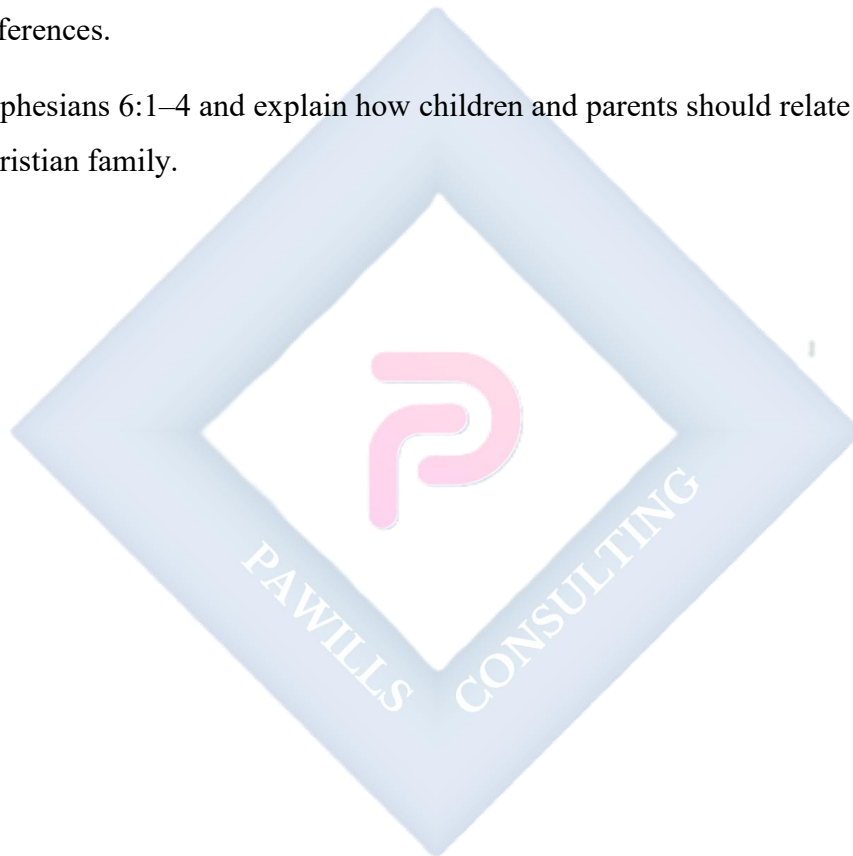
### **EVALUATION**

1. Define the term "family."
2. List and explain the two main types of family.

3. State two examples of other family forms apart from the nuclear and extended family.
4. Identify four family members and their roles.
5. Why is it important to recognize family members?

### ASSIGNMENT

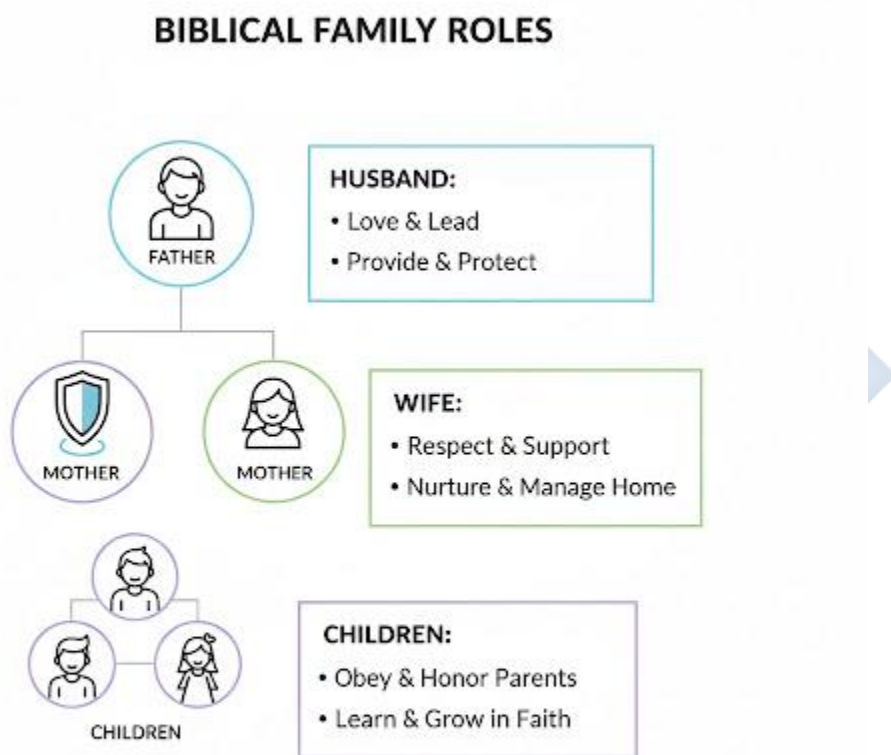
1. Write short notes on the **nuclear** and **extended** families, highlighting their similarities and differences.
2. Read Ephesians 6:1–4 and explain how children and parents should relate to one another in a Christian family.



## WEEK 2: RELATIONSHIP IN THE FAMILY II

### Roles of Family Members (Ephesians 6:1–9; Colossians 3:18–21; 1 Peter 3:1–7)

The family is the smallest and most important unit of society. God designed the family as the first community where love, care, and obedience are taught and practiced. Every member of the family has specific roles to play in order for peace, unity, and progress to be maintained. The Bible provides clear instructions about these roles in passages such as Ephesians 6:1–9, Colossians 3:18–21, and 1 Peter 3:1–7.



### Roles of Family Members

#### 1. Roles of Children (Ephesians 6:1–3; Colossians 3:20)

- Children are commanded to obey their parents in the Lord because it is right.
- They must respect, listen to, and follow their parents' instructions.

- Honouring father and mother comes with a promise: “that it may be well with you and you may live long on the earth.”
- Children should be hardworking, truthful, and disciplined to bring joy to their parents.
- They should avoid stubbornness, laziness, and disobedience, which bring sorrow to their families.

## **2. Roles of Parents (Fathers and Mothers) (Ephesians 6:4; Colossians 3:21)**

- Parents are to train their children in the fear of God.
- They should provide for the physical, spiritual, emotional, and educational needs of their children.
- They must discipline their children with love and not provoke them to anger.
- Parents should serve as role models by living good Christian lives.
- They should encourage, correct, and guide their children with patience.
- Parents must create a loving and peaceful environment at home.

## **3. Roles of Wives (Colossians 3:18; 1 Peter 3:1–6)**

- Wives are commanded to submit to their husbands as it is fitting in the Lord.
- They should show respect, love, and loyalty to their husbands.
- They must support their husbands in caring for the family.
- They should manage the home wisely, ensuring orderliness and hospitality.
- They are expected to be humble, prayerful, and modest in behaviour and appearance.

## **4. Roles of Husbands (Colossians 3:19; Ephesians 5:25–28; 1 Peter 3:7)**

- Husbands must love their wives just as Christ loved the Church and gave Himself for it.
- They should not be harsh, bitter, or abusive towards their wives.
- They must provide for the family’s needs and offer spiritual leadership.

- Husbands should honour their wives and treat them as partners in marriage.
- They are to be patient, protective, and supportive.

#### **5. Roles of Servants/Workers (Ephesians 6:5–8)**

- Servants or workers in the household should obey their masters with sincerity and respect.
- They should work as though serving Christ, not only when being watched.
- They must be diligent, trustworthy, and faithful in their duties.

#### **6. Roles of Masters/Employers (Ephesians 6:9)**

- Masters must treat their servants justly and fairly.
- They should not threaten or exploit their workers.
- They must remember that they too have a Master in heaven who judges all.

### **Lessons from the Biblical Teaching on Family Roles**

1. God is the author of the family and has set clear roles for each member.
2. When family members play their roles faithfully, there will be peace, love, and progress.
3. Disobedience, harshness, disrespect, and neglect of responsibilities destroy family unity.
4. Love, submission, obedience, discipline, and fairness are essential virtues in the home.
5. Families that honour God in their relationships serve as good examples to the society.

### **Evaluation**

1. State three roles of children in the family according to the Bible.
2. Mention four responsibilities of parents towards their children.
3. What does the Bible say about the roles of wives in the family?
4. According to Ephesians 5:25–28, how should husbands treat their wives?

5. List two responsibilities of servants/workers and two responsibilities of masters/employers.
6. Explain two lessons Christians can learn from the biblical teaching on family roles.

### **Assignment**

1. Write short notes on the roles of:
  - a. Children
  - b. Parents
  - c. Husbands
  - d. Wives
2. In what ways can neglecting family roles affect society negatively? Give at least four examples.
3. Imagine you are the head of your family in the future. Describe how you would ensure love, peace, and unity in your home.



### WEEK 3: RELATIONSHIP IN THE FAMILY III – CONCEPT OF A GOOD FAMILY NAME

*(Proverbs 22:1; Ecclesiastes 7:1)*

A family is not only known by the people who belong to it but also by the reputation it carries in society. The Bible emphasizes the importance of having a good name. Proverbs 22:1 says: “*A good name is to be chosen rather than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold.*” Similarly, Ecclesiastes 7:1 says: “*A good name is better than precious ointment.*” These verses show that a good family name is more valuable than wealth, possessions, or material beauty.



## Meaning of a Good Family Name

A good family name refers to the honour, respect, and integrity that a family is known for. It is the positive reputation that people associate with members of a household because of their good behaviour, honesty, love, unity, discipline, and service to others.

When a family has a good name, people trust them, admire them, and regard them as role models in society. On the other hand, a bad family name comes from dishonesty, immorality, violence, laziness, or corruption.

## Biblical Teachings on a Good Name

| Scripture        | Teaching                                                                                                                    |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Proverbs 22:1    | A good name is more valuable than riches. It shows that wealth cannot replace character and reputation.                     |
| Ecclesiastes 7:1 | A good name is better than precious ointment, meaning it lasts longer and is more beneficial than outward beauty or luxury. |

The Bible teaches that what people say about our character is more important than what we possess. Riches can be lost, but a good name lives on even after a person's death.

## How a Good Family Name is Built

A good family name does not happen automatically. It is built over time through the way parents train their children and how each member behaves. Some ways a good family name is built include:

- Living in truth, honesty, and integrity.
- Respecting elders and obeying the laws of the land.
- Showing love, unity, and cooperation within the family.
- Working hard and avoiding laziness.

- Training children to be disciplined, God-fearing, and responsible.
- Keeping away from crime, corruption, cultism, and immoral acts.
- Living peacefully with neighbours and contributing positively to society.

### Importance of a Good Family Name

| Importance         | Explanation                                                                                                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Trust and Respect  | Families with good names are trusted and respected by others in society.                                    |
| Opportunities      | A good family name can open doors to opportunities, because people are more willing to associate with them. |
| Lasting Legacy     | A good name continues even after death, unlike wealth which fades away.                                     |
| God's Approval     | God honours families that live in righteousness and maintain integrity.                                     |
| Positive Influence | Families with good names become role models for others to emulate.                                          |

### Examples in the Bible

1. **The family of Abraham** – respected for faith and obedience to God.
2. **The family of David** – though not perfect, David's name is remembered as "a man after God's own heart."
3. **The family of Eli** – had a bad name because his children were corrupt and disobedient. This shows how careless living can destroy a family's good name.

### Relevance of a Good Family Name Today

In today's society, many people chase after money, wealth, and fame, often neglecting the importance of good character. However, a good family name is still very valuable because it brings honour, trust, and long-lasting respect. Parents and children must strive to protect their family reputation by living uprightly and obeying God's word.

### **Evaluation**

1. Explain the meaning of a good family name.
2. Compare Proverbs 22:1 and Ecclesiastes 7:1 on the value of a good name.
3. State four ways families can build and maintain a good name.
4. Mention three benefits of having a good family name.
5. Give one example of a family with a good name and one with a bad name in the Bible.

### **Assignment**

Write short notes on:

- (a) Why the Bible values a good name more than riches.
- (b) Two practical ways you can contribute to protecting your family's good name.

## WEEK 4: RELATIONSHIP IN THE SCHOOL I

- Names of members of the school
- Choosing friends in school

### INTRODUCTION

Human beings are created to live together and to relate with one another. A school is a community where students, teachers, and other staff members interact daily. For learning to take place effectively, healthy and positive relationships must exist among all members of the school. One of the most important ways to build good relationships in school is through knowing people by their names and choosing the right kind of friends. Names help us to identify people and make communication easier, while choosing friends wisely helps us to live peacefully, avoid trouble, and achieve success in school.



## THE CHOICE OF FRIENDSHIP

## NAMES OF MEMBERS OF THE SCHOOL

Every school is made up of different categories of people, and each person is important in the functioning of the school. Knowing their names is a sign of respect, friendliness, and good relationship. The main members of the school include:

1. **The Principal/Head Teacher:** The overall leader of the school who manages both staff and students.
2. **Vice Principal(s):** Assist the principal in administrative duties.
3. **Teachers:** Responsible for teaching, guiding, and disciplining students.
4. **Students:** Learners in the school who acquire knowledge and skills.
5. **Non-Teaching Staff:** These include bursars, clerks, secretaries, and office assistants who help with administrative work.
6. **Support Staff:** Workers such as cleaners, security personnel, cooks, gardeners, and drivers who provide services that make the school run smoothly.

Knowing the names of members of the school fosters respect and closeness. For example, students who greet their teachers and fellow students by name show good manners and build stronger bonds. Likewise, remembering the names of classmates helps in cooperation and group work.

## CHOOSING FRIENDS IN SCHOOL

Friendship is a close relationship between two or more people who share common interests, goals, or values. In school, students spend a lot of time together, so it is natural to form friendships. However, the kind of friends one chooses can greatly affect one's behaviour, character, and academic performance.

### Qualities of a Good Friend

A good friend in school should be:

- **Honest:** Truthful and trustworthy in words and actions.

- **Respectful:** Shows regard for teachers, school rules, and other students.
- **Hardworking:** Encourages academic success by studying and doing assignments.
- **Obedient:** Listens to instructions from teachers and elders.
- **Caring and Supportive:** Ready to help others in times of need.
- **God-fearing:** Avoids evil habits and encourages righteous living.

### **Dangers of Bad Friendship**

The Bible warns in *1 Corinthians 15:33* that “bad company corrupts good morals.” Choosing the wrong friends can lead to:

- Disobedience to school rules.
- Involvement in lying, stealing, fighting, or examination malpractice.
- Poor academic performance due to laziness.
- Loss of respect for teachers and parents.
- Bad reputation both in and outside the school.

### **Guidelines for Choosing Friends in School**

1. Choose friends who respect God, teachers, and school rules.
2. Make friends who have positive attitudes towards learning.
3. Avoid friends who are troublesome, dishonest, or lazy.
4. Build friendships with classmates who encourage and support you in doing the right thing.
5. Remember that friendship is a choice—students should prayerfully and wisely select those they associate with.

### **BIBLICAL CONNECTION**



The Bible shows that good relationships and friendships are important. Proverbs 13:20 says, “He who walks with wise men shall be wise, but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.” This means that good friends can influence us positively, while bad friends can ruin our future. Just as Jonathan was a good friend to David (1 Samuel 18:1–4), students are encouraged to seek friendships that will help them grow in love, respect, and godliness.

## EVALUATION

1. Who are the members of the school community? Mention at least five.
2. Why is it important to know the names of people in the school?
3. Define friendship in your own words.
4. Mention four qualities of a good friend.
5. What are three dangers of keeping bad friends in school?
6. Explain two biblical teachings that guide us in choosing friends.

## ASSIGNMENT

1. Write down the names of at least **five members of your school staff** (both teaching and non-teaching) and explain one duty of each.
2. In your own words, write a short essay on: **“The kind of friends I want in school and why.”**

## WEEK 6: RELATIONSHIP IN THE SCHOOL II

*Biblical examples of friendship (1 Samuel 18:1–5; Luke 11:5–13)*

### INTRODUCTION

Human beings are social by nature. We are created by God to live in relationship with one another. In schools, relationships are very important because students spend much of their time interacting with classmates, teachers, and peers. One of the most important forms of relationship in the school setting is **friendship**. Good friendship helps students to learn better, behave well, and feel supported, while bad friendship can lead to problems such as disobedience, misconduct, or poor academic performance.

The Bible provides examples of true friendship that can guide students on how to relate with one another in love, trust, and loyalty. Two of such examples are the friendship between **Jonathan and David** (1 Samuel 18:1–5) and Jesus' teaching about friendship (Luke 11:5–13).



## **BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF FRIENDSHIP**

### **1. The Friendship of David and Jonathan (1 Samuel 18:1–5)**

After David defeated Goliath, he was brought before King Saul. Jonathan, the son of Saul, immediately developed a strong bond of love and friendship with David. Their relationship is one of the most outstanding examples of true friendship in the Bible.

- **Mutual Love and Loyalty:** The Bible says that Jonathan loved David as his own soul. This shows deep affection and commitment, not based on selfish interest but genuine care.
- **Covenant of Friendship:** Jonathan and David made a covenant, which is a serious promise or agreement. This shows that their friendship was built on trust, faithfulness, and mutual support.
- **Sacrifice and Selflessness:** Jonathan gave David his robe, armor, sword, bow, and belt. These were symbols of his status as the prince and heir to Saul's throne. By giving them to David, Jonathan showed humility, generosity, and willingness to sacrifice his own privileges for the sake of his friend.
- **Protection and Support:** Later in the story, Jonathan risked his own life to protect David from Saul's jealousy and hatred. This teaches that true friendship stands firm in times of danger and difficulty.

From this story, students learn that friendship must be based on love, loyalty, trust, sacrifice, and mutual respect.

### **2. Jesus' Teaching about Friendship (Luke 11:5–13)**

In this passage, Jesus gave a parable about a man who went to his friend at midnight to ask for bread because he had a visitor. Though it was inconvenient, the friend eventually gave him what he needed because of his persistence.

- **Availability in Times of Need:** A true friend is one who is available, even at inconvenient times, to help others.

- **Generosity and Sharing:** Friendship involves sharing what we have with others, especially when they are in need.
- **Persistence and Understanding:** The passage also teaches that friends should be patient and persistent in helping each other.

Jesus concluded by teaching that if human friends can help one another in times of need, then God our heavenly Father is much more willing to give good things to His children when they ask Him. Thus, friendship also reflects God's love.

### CHARACTERISTICS OF TRUE FRIENDSHIP (FROM THE BIBLE EXAMPLES)

1. **Love and Care:** Friends should genuinely care for one another (Jonathan loved David as himself).
2. **Trust and Loyalty:** Friendship is built on trust and faithfulness, not betrayal.
3. **Sacrifice:** A friend should be willing to give up something valuable for the sake of the other.
4. **Support in Times of Trouble:** True friends stand by each other in difficult times.
5. **Generosity:** Friendship involves giving, sharing, and meeting each other's needs.
6. **Godliness:** Christian friendship should honor God and help each person grow spiritually and morally.

### APPLICATION TO SCHOOL RELATIONSHIPS

- Students should learn to choose friends who are honest, obedient, respectful, and hardworking, because "bad company corrupts good morals" (1 Corinthians 15:33).
- Friends in school should support each other in academics by studying together, sharing notes, and encouraging one another to work hard.

- True friends do not lead others into bad habits such as lying, stealing, fighting, disobedience, examination malpractice, or disrespecting teachers.
- Friendship in school should be based on love, respect, truthfulness, and the fear of God.
- Students should remember that being a true friend means being ready to help and support others, not only when it is convenient but also in times of difficulty.

## EVALUATION

1. Explain what is meant by friendship.
2. Narrate the story of David and Jonathan's friendship in 1 Samuel 18:1–5.
3. Identify three qualities of Jonathan that made him a true friend to David.
4. Summarize the parable of Jesus in Luke 11:5–13 and its lesson on friendship.
5. State four characteristics of true friendship according to the Bible.
6. Mention three ways students can practice good friendship in school.

## ASSIGNMENT

Write short notes on the following:

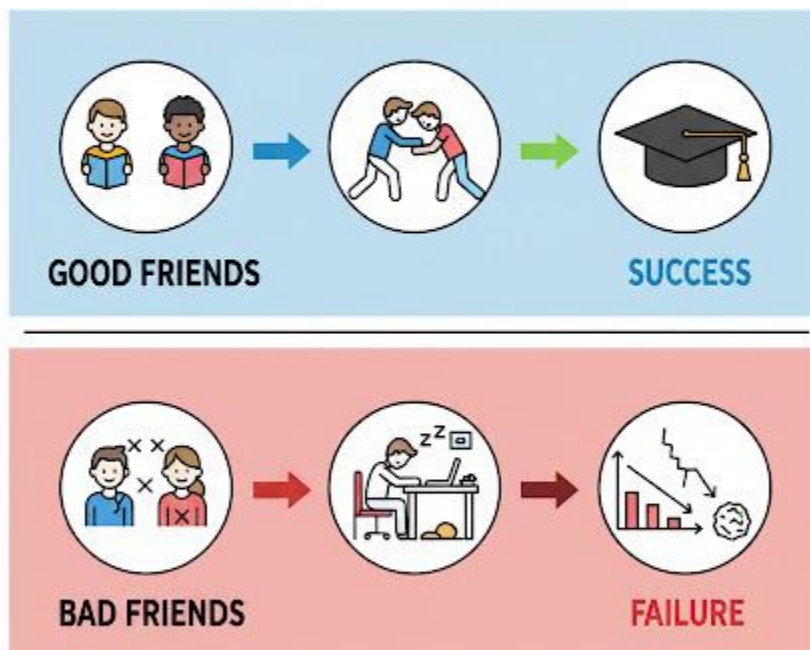
1. **How Jonathan showed true friendship to David.**
2. **What Jesus taught about friendship in Luke 11:5–13.**
3. **How you can apply the lessons of biblical friendship to your relationships in school.**

## WEEK 8: RELATIONSHIP IN THE SCHOOL III

Human beings are social in nature, and relationships form a vital part of life, especially in school. The school environment brings together people of different backgrounds, characters, and attitudes. As students, the kind of friends we choose determines whether we succeed or fail in academics, morals, and spiritual life. Good friends encourage us to live rightly, while bad friends lead us into disobedience, laziness, and sin.

The Bible speaks about friendship and warns against keeping the wrong company. Proverbs 1:10–12 says, *“My son, if sinners entice you, do not consent.”* Likewise, 2 Thessalonians 3:6–13 encourages Christians to stay away from unruly people and not associate with those who live in laziness or disobedience. This shows that building the right relationship is a command from God and a key to living a successful life.

### Consequences of Friendship





## Importance of Good Friends

Good friends are those who influence us positively and encourage us to grow in godly character, discipline, and excellence. In school, the importance of having good friends includes:

1. **Academic Encouragement:** Good friends help one another in studies, share ideas, and encourage each other to work hard. They help in revising notes, solving assignments, and preparing for tests.
2. **Moral Support:** A true friend stands by you in difficult times, offering encouragement, comfort, and wise counsel.
3. **Good Character Building:** Good friends discourage immoral behavior and help one to develop virtues such as honesty, respect, humility, and kindness.
4. **Spiritual Growth:** Friends who love God help one another to pray, study the Bible, and live a godly life. They keep each other accountable in their Christian journey.
5. **Protection from Wrong Influence:** With the right company, it becomes easier to resist peer pressure and avoid temptation.
6. **Teamwork and Cooperation:** Good friends encourage cooperation in group work, sports, and school activities, leading to collective success.

## Consequences of Bad Friends (Proverbs 1:10–12; 2 Thess. 3:6–13)

The Bible clearly warns against associating with bad friends. Bad friends are those who engage in sinful or unruly acts and attempt to lure others into them. Keeping such friends has dangerous consequences, such as:

1. **Influence to Sin:** Proverbs 1:10–12 warns that sinners will entice others to join in evil acts such as lying, stealing, fighting, or cheating. Yielding to such temptation leads to sin against God and punishment.
2. **Laziness and Irresponsibility:** 2 Thessalonians 3:6–13 warns against walking disorderly or becoming lazy. Bad friends discourage seriousness in academics and promote idleness.
3. **Destruction of Future:** Associating with bad friends can lead to expulsion from school, police cases, or ruining one's chances of a bright future.



4. **Loss of Good Reputation:** A person is often judged by the company he or she keeps. If one keeps bad friends, people will assume the person is also bad.
5. **Spiritual Weakness:** Bad friends weaken one's faith, discourage church attendance, and may lead one away from God.
6. **Separation from God:** Continued association with bad company can cause disobedience, sin, and ultimately separation from God's blessings.

### Lessons from the Bible Passages

- **Proverbs 1:10–12** teaches that we must resist peer pressure and refuse to follow friends who plan evil.
- **2 Thessalonians 3:6–13** reminds us to keep away from lazy and disobedient people who refuse to work or live orderly lives. Christians must live responsibly, work hard, and encourage one another to do good.

### Evaluation

1. Explain the importance of having good friends in school.
2. Mention four consequences of keeping bad friends.
3. According to Proverbs 1:10–12, what should a Christian student do when sinners entice him?
4. How does 2 Thessalonians 3:6–13 describe unruly people, and what advice does it give Christians about them?
5. State three ways good friends can help in spiritual growth.

### Assignment

Write an essay on the topic: **“The Role of Friendship in My Academic and Spiritual Life.”**

In your essay, discuss the benefits of good friends, the dangers of bad friends, and give examples of how friendship can affect a student’s future.



## WEEK 9: RELATIONSHIP IN THE COMMUNITY I

### *Community Leaders; Ways of Sustaining Relationships in the Community*

#### Community Leaders

Every community is made up of different people who live, work, and interact together. For peace and progress to exist, there must be leaders who guide, direct, and coordinate the activities of the people. These leaders are responsible for maintaining law and order, ensuring justice, and promoting unity within the community.

Community leaders are individuals who occupy positions of authority and respect within the society. They may be traditional, political, or religious leaders, and each plays a special role in the life of the community.



- **Traditional leaders:** These include kings, chiefs, elders, and family heads who preserve the customs, traditions, and cultural heritage of the people. They often settle disputes, maintain peace, and serve as custodians of the land.

- **Political leaders:** These include elected representatives such as councillors, local government chairmen, governors, and other officials. They make policies, provide infrastructure, and ensure good governance.
- **Religious leaders:** These are pastors, priests, imams, and other spiritual heads who guide people morally and spiritually. They teach values such as honesty, kindness, obedience, and love.
- **Other leaders in the community:** Teachers, heads of associations, and youth leaders also contribute to guiding, training, and shaping the younger generation.

Community leaders are expected to lead by example, be honest, and seek the welfare of the people under them.

### Ways of Sustaining Relationships in the Community

Good relationships in the community are essential for unity, peace, and development. The Bible teaches Christians to “love your neighbour as yourself” (Mark 12:31), which is the foundation for sustaining community life.

Some important ways of sustaining relationships in the community include:

1. **Love and mutual respect** – Community members must show love, care, and respect for one another regardless of age, tribe, or religion.
2. **Obedience to community leaders** – Members should obey laws, rules, and regulations made for the good of the community.
3. **Peaceful co-existence** – Avoiding quarrels, violence, and fighting helps to maintain harmony. Conflicts should be resolved peacefully.
4. **Cooperation and participation** – Members should take part in community development projects such as sanitation, building roads, schools, and health centres.
5. **Honesty and trustworthiness** – People should keep promises, avoid stealing, and be truthful in their dealings with one another.

6. **Care for the needy** – The poor, widows, orphans, and the elderly should be cared for through collective support.
7. **Tolerance** – Members should learn to tolerate differences in opinion, belief, and background without discrimination.
8. **Prayer and moral guidance** – Communities should seek God’s guidance and live by moral and spiritual values to ensure lasting peace.

A community where relationships are sustained through these values will enjoy peace, progress, and God’s blessings.

### **Evaluation**

1. Who is a community leader?
2. Mention three types of community leaders and explain their roles.
3. List four ways of sustaining relationships in the community.
4. Explain the importance of obedience in maintaining community relationships.
5. State one Bible verse that supports love and unity in the community.

### **Assignment**

Write short notes on **two community leaders you know** in your locality and explain how their leadership has helped to sustain good relationships among the people.

## WEEK 10: RELATIONSHIP IN THE CHURCH

- Relationship in the church
- Importance of fellowship and unity

### INTRODUCTION

The church is the family of God, where Christians come together to worship, pray, learn God's word, and serve one another. It is not just the building but the people who gather in the name of Christ. Just as family members relate with one another in love, respect, and cooperation, members of the church are also expected to build strong and healthy relationships. Good relationships in the church are necessary for growth, peace, and the fulfillment of God's will.

In *Acts 2:42–47*, the early Christians gave us an example of how believers should relate: they prayed together, studied God's word, ate together, and shared their possessions with one another. Their unity and fellowship made the church strong and attracted more people to join them.



## RELATIONSHIP IN THE CHURCH

Relationship in the church refers to how members of the Christian community interact with one another and with God. A good relationship in the church is based on love, respect, service, forgiveness, and obedience to God's word.

Ways Christians relate in the church include:

1. **Worshipping Together:** Singing, praying, and praising God in unity.
2. **Studying the Word of God:** Listening to sermons, attending Bible study, and Sunday school classes.
3. **Praying for One Another:** Supporting each other in times of need through intercession.
4. **Showing Love and Care:** Visiting the sick, giving to the poor, and comforting the sorrowful.
5. **Working Together in Service:** Participating in church activities like choir, ushers, drama group, or evangelism.
6. **Obedying Leaders:** Respecting pastors, elders, and other leaders God has placed in authority.
7. **Forgiving One Another:** Avoiding quarrels, gossip, and divisions, and living in peace with everyone.

A healthy church relationship makes the congregation a family of believers, where everyone feels welcomed and accepted.

## IMPORTANCE OF FELLOWSHIP AND UNITY

The word **fellowship** means coming together to share in worship, prayers, and Christian love. **Unity** means oneness and agreement among church members. Both are very important for the life of the church.

1. **Strengthens the Faith of Believers:** Fellowship helps members encourage one another and grow spiritually.



2. **Creates Love and Care Among Members:** Unity makes believers support one another in times of joy or sorrow.
3. **Promotes Peace in the Church:** When there is unity, there will be no quarrels, divisions, or hatred.
4. **Helps the Church to Grow:** Just as in Acts 2, unity and fellowship attract outsiders who want to experience the love of Christ.
5. **Encourages Sharing of Resources:** Members can share food, money, and skills to help one another.
6. **Shows the World the Love of Christ:** Jesus prayed in *John 17:21* that His followers may be one, so that the world will know that God sent Him. Unity makes the church a living witness of God's love.
7. **Brings God's Blessings:** Psalm 133:1–3 says that where brethren dwell together in unity, the Lord commands His blessings.

### BIBLICAL CONNECTIONS

- **Acts 2:42–47:** The early church devoted themselves to teaching, fellowship, breaking of bread, and prayers.
- **Hebrews 10:25:** Christians are encouraged not to neglect meeting together but to encourage one another.
- **John 17:21:** Jesus prayed for unity among believers.
- **Psalm 133:1:** “Behold, how good and pleasant it is for brethren to dwell together in unity.”

These passages show that fellowship and unity are God's will for His church.

### EVALUATION

1. Explain the meaning of relationship in the church.
2. Mention four ways Christians can build good relationships in the church.
3. What is fellowship, and why is it important?
4. State five benefits of unity in the church.
5. Give two examples of unity among the early Christians as recorded in Acts 2.
6. Quote one Bible passage that shows God's desire for unity among believers.

### ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a short essay explaining: **“Why fellowship is important in my local church.”**
2. Memorize and recite Psalm 133:1 in class, and explain its meaning in your own words.

